



GYAN



*how the printed bracket survived
the first two knockout rounds*

THE KNOCKOUT GRADE, SO FAR

18/24

knockout matches won by the team GYAN printed as the winner,
a **75.0%** read across the Round of 32 and the Round of 16
and **1 of 4** quarterfinals drawn exactly, months before it was scheduled

A pause-and-assess review of the four-expert ensemble against every completed knockout result and the quarterfinal draw. Predictions as published in *The Bracket*. Educational and entertainment use only.

How the knockouts are scored

A knockout match asks two separate questions of a bracket: did you draw this pairing, and did your winner actually win. Each completed match is worth up to 3 points.

+1 THE WINNER CALL

The team GYAN printed as the winner of that bracket position won the match, whoever it ended up facing.

+1 THE EXACT MATCHUP

Both teams in the real tie are the two teams GYAN drew against each other on the printed page.

+1 THE PERFECT TIE

Both at once: right pairing, right winner. The hardest thing a bracket can do, so it earns a bonus.

72

points available in total: 3 per match across **16 Round of 32** matches (48) and **8 Round of 16** matches (24). Percentages are shown next to every raw count.

TWO EDGE CASES, HANDLED HONESTLY

Egypt v Australia had no GYAN pick

Neither team was printed as a Round of 32 winner. Egypt was drawn losing to France, and Australia was not in the bracket at all. The match scores zero across the board and is labeled a **no call**, not a miss of a pick that never existed. Percentages are shown both ways.

Spain v Portugal held two printed winners

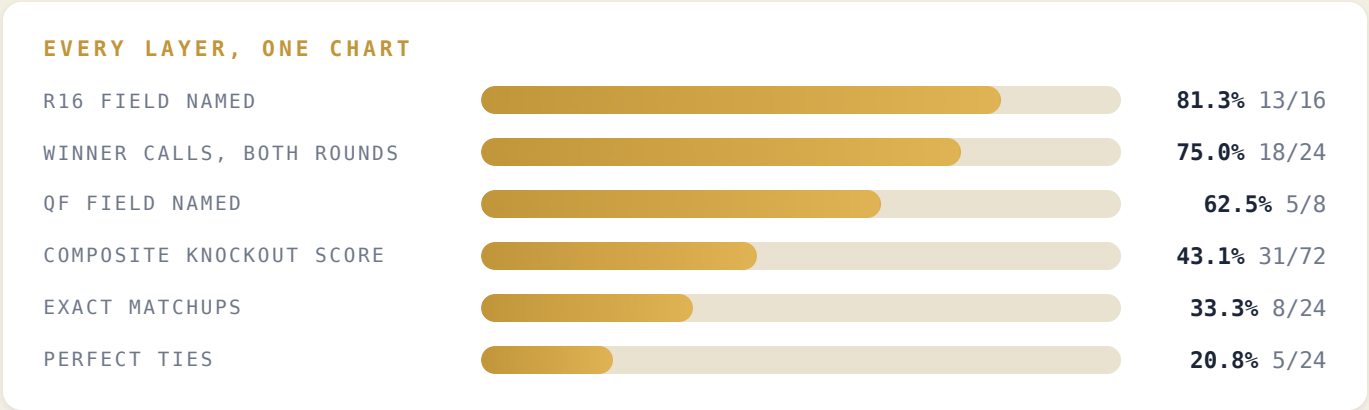
Both were printed as Round of 16 winners, and they met, so one call had to fail. Each tie is graded on the winner GYAN printed **for that bracket slot**: Spain was the call here, and Portugal's failed slot is graded where its side of the bracket actually fell, in the Switzerland tie.

SOURCES

The Round of 32 ran June 28 to July 3 and the Round of 16 ran July 4 to 7. Every score and the full quarterfinal draw were taken from FIFA's match centre and cross-checked against Yahoo Sports, Olympics.com, FOX Sports, ESPN, UEFA.com, and Sky Sports; all sources agree on every figure used here.

The checkpoint at a glance

Winner calls are where the model earns its keep. Exact pairings are strict by design, because one upset upstream reshuffles who meets whom.



How to read the gap. Naming who advances is a strength test and GYAN passes it: 13 of 16 into the last sixteen, 5 of 8 into the last eight, and 18 of 24 matches won by the printed team. Landing the exact pairing also requires every upstream result to cooperate, which is why those layers sit lower and pull the composite to 43.1%. The distribution is the product; the printed bracket is a snapshot.

Sixteen matches, thirteen hits

Every completed Round of 32 result against the printed page. Bold marks the actual winner.

13/15

WINNER CALLS ·
86.7%

5/16

EXACT PAIRINGS ·
31.3%

3/16

PERFECT TIES

21/48

POINTS · 43.8%

 **South Africa 0–1**  **Canada**

GYAN drew: South Korea v Canada, Canada to win

HIT

 **Brazil 2–1**  **Japan**

GYAN drew: Brazil v Japan, Brazil to win

PERFECT

 **Germany 1–1**  **Paraguay** Paraguay

win 4-3 pens

GYAN drew: Germany v Paraguay, Germany to win

MISS · PENS

 **Netherlands 1–1**  **Morocco** Morocco

win 3-2 pens

GYAN drew: Netherlands v Morocco, Netherlands to win

MISS · PENS

 **Ivory Coast 1–2**  **Norway**

GYAN drew: Ecuador v Norway, Norway to win

HIT

 **France 3–0**  **Sweden**

GYAN drew: France v Egypt, France to win

HIT

 **Mexico 2–0**  **Ecuador**

GYAN drew: Mexico v Ivory Coast, Mexico to win

HIT

 **England 2–1**  **DR Congo**

GYAN drew: England v DR Congo, England to win

PERFECT

 **Belgium 3–2**  **Senegal** aet

GYAN drew: Belgium v Czechia, Belgium to win

HIT

 **USA 2–0**  **Bosnia**

GYAN drew: USA v Bosnia, USA to win

PERFECT

 **Spain 3–0**  **Austria**

GYAN drew: Spain v Algeria, Spain to win

HIT

 **Portugal 2–1**  **Croatia**

GYAN drew: Portugal v Senegal, Portugal to win

HIT

 **Switzerland 2–0**  **Algeria**

GYAN drew: Switzerland v Austria, Switzerland to win

HIT

 **Egypt 1–1**  **Australia** Egypt win 4-2 pens

GYAN drew: neither team printed as a winner

NO CALL

 **Argentina 3–2**  **Cape Verde** aet

GYAN drew: Argentina v Uruguay, Argentina to win

HIT

 **Colombia 1–0**  **Ghana**

GYAN drew: Colombia v Croatia, Colombia to win

HIT

Coin flips and outsiders

Three things explain almost everything that happened to the bracket in the first knockout round.

01 BOTH MISSES CAME FROM TWELVE YARDS

GYAN's only two failed winner calls were  Germany and the  Netherlands, and both were 1–1 draws decided on penalties, to  Paraguay (4–3) and  Morocco (3–2). Neither printed winner lost inside ninety minutes or in extra time. A shootout is close to a pure 50-50, which is about the softest way a forecast can miss. Both, notably, were **exact pairings** GYAN had drawn correctly.

02 THE FIVE OUTSIDERS ALL WENT HOME

 South Africa,  Sweden,  Cape Verde,  Ghana and  Australia all reached the Round of 32 from outside GYAN's printed field, and all five were eliminated in it. Australia v Egypt guaranteed one of GYAN's non-picks a place in the last sixteen by construction; it went to  Egypt, on penalties, in the one tie where the model had no call at all.

03 TEN SWAPPED TIES, TEN WINS

In ten ties the printed winner faced a **different opponent** than the one GYAN drew: Canada, Norway, France, Mexico, Belgium, Spain, Portugal, Switzerland, Argentina and Colombia. All ten won anyway. Every one of GYAN's winner calls that failed did so inside an exact pairing, never in a reshuffled one. The reshuffles swap in a team that finished lower than the drawn opponent, so the printed favorite usually gets an easier tie, not a harder one.

THE ROUND OF 16 FIELD, AS NAMED

GYAN named **13 of the 16** teams that reached the Round of 16, an **81.3%** read. The three it missed:  Germany,  Netherlands and  Turkey. The three that came instead:  Paraguay,  Morocco and  Egypt, two of them by shootout and one, Turkey's, lost back in the groups.

Eight matches, and a pattern

Each tie is graded against the winner GYAN printed for that bracket slot. Bold marks the actual winner.

5/8WINNER CALLS ·
62.5%**6/8**WINNING SIDES ·
75.0%**3/8**EXACT PAIRINGS ·
37.5%**10/24**

POINTS · 41.7%

 **Morocco 3–0**  Canada

GYAN drew: Canada v Netherlands, Netherlands to win this slot

SLOT HIT

 **France 1–0**  Paraguay

GYAN drew: Germany v France, France to win this slot

HIT

 **Norway 2–1**  Brazil

GYAN drew: Brazil v Norway, Brazil to win this slot

MISS

 **England 3–2**  Mexico

GYAN drew: Mexico v England, England to win this slot

PERFECT

 **Spain 1–0**  Portugal

GYAN drew: Colombia v Spain, Spain to win this slot

HIT

 **Belgium 4–1**  USA

GYAN drew: USA v Belgium, Belgium to win this slot

PERFECT

 **Argentina 3–2**  Egypt

GYAN drew: Argentina v Turkey, Argentina to win this slot

HIT

 **Switzerland 0–0**  Colombia Switzerland win 4-3 pens

GYAN drew: Switzerland v Portugal, Portugal to win this slot

MISS

THE SLOT PATTERN, NAMED AND STRESS-TESTED

 Morocco v  Canada is the cleanest case: GYAN's printed team was gone, but the team that removed it stepped into the same bracket position and produced the same printed outcome, a 3–0 win over Canada from the Netherlands' slot. Count winning *sides* instead of names and GYAN goes 6 of 8. But the same logic failed twice in this round:  Norway beat  Brazil inside an exactly-predicted tie, the one true upset against the model so far, and  Switzerland won the tie played in Portugal's pathway. Slots carry real signal because seeding concentrates strength. They are a tendency, not a law.

The quarterfinals, against the page

Four ties are set. One of them has been on GYAN's printed page since before the tournament began.

THU JUL 9 · BOSTON

ONE OF TWO

 France v  Morocco

GYAN drew France v Netherlands; Morocco took Netherlands' place

FRI JUL 10 · LOS ANGELES

EXACT

 Spain v  Belgium

called in advance: printed on page four of The Bracket, now on the schedule

SAT JUL 11 · MIAMI

ONE OF TWO

 England v  Norway

GYAN drew Brazil v England; Norway took Brazil's place

SAT JUL 11 · KANSAS CITY

ONE OF TWO

 Argentina v  Switzerland

GYAN drew Argentina v Portugal; Switzerland took Portugal's place

EVERY QUARTERFINALIST WAS ALREADY ON THE PAGE

All eight quarterfinalists appear in GYAN's printed bracket; not one arrived from outside the model's knockout picture. The three GYAN did not place in the last eight,  Morocco,  Norway and  Switzerland, each now occupies the slot of the exact pathway GYAN drew it losing in. Morocco was drawn losing to the Netherlands, beat them, and took their path. Norway was drawn losing to Brazil, beat them, and took their path. Switzerland was drawn losing to Portugal and won the tie played in Portugal's pathway.

4/4 PRINTED SEMIFINALISTS ALIVE

 France,  Spain,  England and  Argentina each sit in a different quarterfinal. The printed semifinal lineup is still fully achievable.

THE CHAMPION PATH IS INTACT

The printed final,  Spain v  England, and the printed champion, Spain at **13.2%**, both remain in play. Spain has yet to concede a goal at this World Cup.

The Knockout Score: 31 of 72

All three layers, both rounds, one number. Strict on purpose.

STAGE	WINNER CALLS	EXACT MATCHUPS	PERFECT TIES	POINTS
Round of 32	13/16	5/16	3/16	21/48 · 43.8%
Round of 16	5/8	3/8	2/8	10/24 · 41.7%
Total	18/24 · 75.0%	8/24	5/24	31/72 · 43.1%

FOUR TAKEAWAYS INTO THE QUARTERFINALS

- 1. **The winner engine is running hot.** 18 of 24 knockout matches (75.0%) went to the printed team; where GYAN’s printed advancer was actually on the field, 18 of 21 (85.7%). Its only two Round of 32 misses both came on penalties.
- 2. **The slot pattern held more often than not,** ten of ten in the Round of 32 and six of eight slots in the Round of 16, but Brazil’s exit to Norway is the reminder that it is a tendency, not a rule.
- 3. **Nothing about the endgame has been eliminated.** The printed semifinal four, the printed final, and the printed champion are all intact. No round has yet touched the model’s core call.
- 4. **The quarterfinals are the real test.** France, Spain, England and Argentina all play in slots the model called for them. The next checkpoint lands when those four ties are done.

GYAN: Goal-model, Yield-weighted Aggregation, simulationN. Four experts, 100,000 simulated tournaments, one printed bracket.
Reviewed against results verified across FIFA, Yahoo, Olympics.com, FOX, ESPN, UEFA and Sky.